PEW RESEARCH CENTER
FEBRUARY 9-12, 2012 OMNIBUS
FINAL TOPLINE
N=1,000

ASK ALL:

PEW.1 As I read a list of some stories covered by news organizations this past week, please tell me if you happened to follow each news story very closely, fairly closely, not too closely, or not at all closely. First, **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE;] [IF NECESSARY** "Did you follow **[ITEM]** very closely, fairly closely, not too closely or not at all closely?"**]**

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
a. Reports about the condition of the U.S. economy					
February 9-12, 2012	42	30	14	13	1
February 2-5, 2012	38	32	16	13	1
January 26-29, 2012	35	31	16	19	*
January 19-22, 2012	35	30	16	19	1
January 12-15, 2012	33	32	14	20	1
January 5-8, 2012	39	31	15	15	*
December 15-18, 2011	36	32	14	16	1
December 8-11, 2011	41	29	13	16	1
December 1-4, 2011	40	33	13	13	1
November 17-20, 2011	35	33	16	15	1
November 10-13, 2011	39	31	15	14	*
November 3-6, 2011	37	31	15	17	1
October 27-30, 2011	38	33	14	15	1
October 20-23, 2011	38	32	14	16	1
October 13-16, 2011	39	32	14	14	*
October 6-9, 2011	43	28	14	14	1
September 29-October 2, 2011	46	26	14	14	*
September 22-25, 2011	44	33	11	11	*
September 8-11, 2011	40	30	15	14	1
September 1-4, 2011	44	30	11	15	*
August 25-28, 2011	44	28	14	13	1
August 18-21, 2011	44	29	12	14	1
August 4-7, 2011	46	30	11	13	1
July 28-31, 2011	43	30	13	13	*
July 21-24, 2011	41	32	13	13	1
July 14-17, 2011	41	30	14	14	1
July 7-10, 2011	36	30	15	18	1
June 30-July 3, 2011	38	32	13	16	1
June 23-26, 2011	37	29	15	19	*
June 16-19, 2011	39	33	14	13	*
June 9-12, 2011	39	30	15	16	1
June 2-5, 2011	35	34	17	14	*
May 19-22, 2011	33	34	17	16	*
May 12-15, 2011	32	32	17	18	2
May 5-8, 2011	40	35	15	9	1
April 21-25, 2011	41	33	12	14	*
April 14-17, 2011	44	30	14	12	1
April 7-10, 2011	46	30	14	10	*
March 31-April 3, 2011	42	31	16	11	0
March 24-27, 2011	36	32	17	15	*
March 17-20, 2011	38	32	17	13	*
March 10-13, 2011	40	30	16	13	*
March 3-6, 2011	37	31	17	13	1
February 24-27, 2011	49	29	11	10	*
February 17-20, 2011	35	33	14	17	*
February 10-13, 2011	36	34	13	16	*
February 3-6, 2011	35	37	14	14	*

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
January 20-23, 2011	37	33	14	15	1
January 13-16, 2011	37	29	15	18	1
January 6-9, 2011	39	37	11	12	1

SEE TRENDS FOR PREVIOUS YEARS: http://www.people-press.org/files/2011/11/NII-Economy-Trends.pdf

b. Political violence in Syria					
February 9-12, 2012	17	23	23	36	*
January 12-15, 2012	12	17	26	45	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
August 4-7, 2011: *Political violence following uprisings in Syria*	10	19	26	44	1
May 5-8, 2011	14	27	30	28	1
June 2-5, 2011: *Anti-government protests and violence in some Middle Eastern countries*	18	25	25	32	*
April 28-May 1, 2011	18	29	25	27	1
February 3-6, 2011: *Anti-government protests in Egypt and other Middle Eastern countries*	32	35	16	18	*
January 27-30, 2011	17	26	21	35	*
c. A federal appeals court ruling that California's ban on gay marriage is unconstitutional					
February 9-12, 2012	16	23	24	37	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
February 24-27, 2011: *Recent developments in the debate over gay marriage*	19	26	20	34	1
May 29-June 1, 2009: *The California Supreme Court upholding a ban on gay marriage*	22	35	19	23	1
May 8-11, 2009: *Steps to legalize gay marriage in Maine and New Hampshire*	16	16	22	45	1
April 9-13, 2009: *The legalization of gay marriage in Iowa and Vermont*	13	21	23	42	1
Nov. 7-10, 2008: *California voting to ban gay marriage*	18	26	24	32	*
June 20-23, 2008: *The issue of same-sex marriage in California*	22	26	25	27	*
May 16-19, 2008: *The California Supreme Court's decision giving same-sex couples the right to marry*	19	27	25	28	1
May 2004: *The issue of gay and lesbian marriage*	20	27	25	27	1
March 2004: *The issue of gay and lesbian marriage*	29	33	20	17	1
Early-February 2004: *The debate about letting gays and lesbians marry*	26	32	22	19	1
Mid-August 2003: *The debate about letting gays and lesbians marry*	19	30	22	28	1
d. Debate over a new rule requiring religious employers, such as Catholic hospitals and universities, to cover birth control in their health insurance plans					
February 9-12, 2012	27	22	20	30	1

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
November 17-20, 2011: *The U.S. Supreme Court agreeing to hear legal challenges to last year's health care reform law*	18	24	24	33	1
February 3-6, 2011: *A federal judge ruling that part of the new health care law is unconstitutional*	25	28	19	28	1
January 20-23, 2011: *News about Republican efforts to repeal last year's health care law*	29	29	20	21	1
December 16-19, 2010: *A federal judge ruling that parts of the new health care law are unconstitutional*	28	24	17	30	1
September 23-26, 2010: *News about portions of this year's health care reform law beginning to take effect*	37	31	17	14	1
April 16-19, 2010: *News about the new health care reform law*	40	30	16	14	*
April 9-12, 2010	46	27	15	12	*
April 1-5, 2010	42	27	14	16	*
March 26-29, 2010: *Debate over health care reform*	49	29	12	10	*
March 19-22, 2010	51	24	11	14	*
March 12-15, 2010	40	31	16	13	*
March 5-8, 2010	42	27	17	15	*
February 26-March 1, 2010	29	29	19	22	*
February 19-22, 2010	33	28	19	19	*
January 29-February 1, 2010	39	27	16	17	*
January 22-25, 2010	41	32	15	11	*
January 15-18, 2010	37	27	19	18	*
January 8-11, 2010	39	26	20	15	*
December 18-21, 2009	42	27	16	14	*
December 11-14, 2009	42	30	15	14	*
December 4-7, 2009	42	28	15	14	1
November 20-23, 2009	42	29	14	15	*
November 13-16, 2009	38	26	17	17	1
November 6-9, 2009	35	28	15	22	1
October 30-November 2, 2009	32	26	19	23	*
October 23-26, 2009	40	27	16	17	1
October 16-19, 2009	36	28	15	21	*
October 9-12, 2009	37	29	14	19	1
October 2-5, 2009	39	29	16	16	*
September 25-28, 2009	45	31	12	12	0
September 18-21, 2009	44	26	19	11	*
September 11-14, 2009	44	27	14	15	*
September 3-6, 2009	40	26	16	17	0
August 28-31, 2009	40	28	17	14	1
August 21-24, 2009	49	24	12	15	1
August 14-17, 2009	39	31	15	15	1
August 7-10, 2009: *Debate in Washington over health care reform*	40	27	17	15	1
July 31-August 3, 2009	47	26	14	13	1
July 24-27, 2009	44	28	15	13	*
July 17-20, 2009	33	31	13	21	2
July 10-13, 2009	24	29	20	27	*
June 26-29, 2009	29	26	20	25	1
June 19-22, 2009	28	28	20	23	*
June 12-15, 2009	29	26	18	26	*

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
May 15-18, 2009: *Debate over Barack Obama's health care plans*	25	30	20	24	*
March 6-9, 2009: *Obama proposing a $630 billion fund for overhauling health care*	41	32	13	14	*
e. Tension between Iran and Israel over Iran's nuclear program					
February 9-12, 2012	26	25	21	29	*
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
January 12-15, 2012: *Mounting tensions between the U.S. and Iran*	24	30	18	27	*
January 5-8, 2012: *Tensions between the U.S. and Iran over shipping in the Persian gulf*	23	26	19	32	*
December 1-4, 2011: *Tensions between Britain and Iran following an attack on the British embassy by Iranian protestors*	12	19	24	44	1
June 10-13, 2010: *New U.N. sanctions against Iran because of its nuclear program*	19	28	25	27	1
March 26-29, 2010: *Reports about tensions between Israel and the United States*	20	27	21	31	1
October 2-5, 2009: *Talks between the United States and Iran over Iran's nuclear program*	30	32	18	20	*
May 21-24, 2009: *Iran testing a missile that could reach Israel*	20	29	25	26	*
July 11-14, 2008: *The Iranian government firing test missiles capable of striking Israel*	25	29	22	23	1
January 11-14, 2008: *News about an encounter between U.S. and Iranian ships*	25	26	21	27	1
December 7-10, 2007: *A new intelligence report stating that Iran stopped its nuclear weapons program in 2003*	25	31	20	23	1
October 26-29, 2007: *Mounting tensions between the United States and Iran*	26	34	21	18	1
September 28 – October 1, 2007: *Iranian President Mahmoud Ahmadinejad's recent trip to New York City where he spoke at Columbia University and the United Nations*	23	31	20	25	1
June 1-4, 2007: *Recent talks between the United States and Iran*	19	27	27	26	1
February 23-26, 2007: *Mounting tensions between the United States and Iran*	29	37	18	15	1
September, 2006: *Iran's nuclear research program*	23	34	19	23	1
August, 2006	24	34	20	20	3
June, 2006	21	32	22	22	3
April, 2006	26	30	23	20	1
March, 2006	24	31	22	22	1
f. News about candidates for the 2012 presidential elections					
February 9-12, 2012	35	25	18	20	1
February 2-5, 2012	30	27	20	21	1
January 26-29, 2012	28	30	21	21	1
January 19-22, 2012	28	30	17	24	*
January 12-15, 2012	29	29	18	23	1
January 5-8, 2012	29	30	16	25	*
December 15-18, 2011	26	24	20	29	1

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
December 8-11, 2011	27	27	18	28	*
December 1-4, 2011	25	28	20	26	1
November 17-20, 2011	24	31	21	23	1
November 3-6, 2011	22	31	20	26	1
October 27-30, 2011	21	26	21	30	1
October 20-23, 2011	21	28	22	28	1
October 13-16, 2011	26	29	22	23	1
October 6-9, 2011	25	25	23	27	1
September 29-October 2, 2011	27	26	21	25	*
September 22-25, 2011	25	26	23	25	1
September 15-18, 2011	24	28	21	27	1
September 8-11, 2011	22	26	21	31	*
September 1-4, 2011	22	23	22	32	1
August 25-28, 2011	22	22	22	33	1
August 18-21, 2011	27	26	19	28	1
August 11-14, 2011	19	24	20	36	1
August 4-7, 2011	18	21	22	37	1
July 28-31, 2011	17	27	21	35	1
July 21-24, 2011	17	22	28	32	*
July 14-17, 2011	18	26	27	28	1
July 7-10, 2011	16	23	27	33	1
June 30-July 3, 2011	21	28	24	25	2
June 23-26, 2011	19	26	24	31	*
June 16-19, 2011	23	29	23	25	*
June 9-12, 2011	18	30	22	30	1
June 2-5, 2011	21	31	22	26	*
May 26-29, 2011	20	27	24	28	*
May 19-22, 2011	15	27	24	32	1
May 12-15, 2011	15	22	26	35	1
May 5-8, 2011	16	24	27	32	1
April 21-25, 2011	18	26	23	32	1
April 14-17, 2011	20	23	29	27	1
March 24-27, 2011	13	19	26	41	1
March 10-13, 2011	15	21	26	38	0
February 10-13, 2011	16	19	24	40	*
February 3-6, 2011	15	20	23	42	*

SEE TRENDS FOR PREVIOUS YEARS: http://www.people-press.org/files/2011/11/NII-Election-Trends.pdf

ASK ALL:

PEW.2 Which ONE of the stories I just mentioned have you followed most closely, or is there another story you've been following MORE closely? **[DO NOT READ LIST. ACCEPT ONLY ONE RESPONSE.]**

Feb 9-12 2012	
25	News about candidates for the 2012 presidential elections
18	Reports about the condition of the U.S. economy
12	Debate over a new rule requiring religious employers, such as Catholic hospitals and universities, to cover birth control in their health insurance plans
9	Tension between Iran and Israel over Iran's nuclear program
5	Political violence in Syria
4	A federal appeals court ruling that California's ban on gay marriage is unconstitutional
8	Some other story **(VOL.)**
18	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

ASK ALL:

PEW.3 Regardless of whom you might prefer, which Republican candidate have you heard the most about in the news recently? **[READ NAMES; RANDOMIZE]**

Feb 9-12 2012		Jan 26-29 2012
50	Mitt Romney	36
19	Rick Santorum	2
13	Newt Gingrich	42
6	Ron Paul	4
2	Other **(VOL.)**	1
11	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**	15

PEW.4 FULL TREND:

Thinking about Republican candidates for president in 2012… Regardless of whom you might prefer, which Republican candidate have you heard the most about in the news recently? ***[OPEN END. RECORD FIRST MENTION ONLY.] [PLEASE BE CERTAIN TO DISTINGUISH BETWEEN "JOHN MCCAIN" AND "HERMAN CAIN".]***

	Jan 12-15 2012	Jan 5-8 2012	Dec 1-4 2011	Oct 13-16 2011	Sep 8-11 2011	Aug 18-21 2011	Jul 21-24 2011	Jun 16-19 2011	Jun 2-5 2011	May 12-15 2011	Apr 14-17 2011
Newt Gingrich	6	11	13	*	1	1	1	5	2	12	1
Mitt Romney	51	39	5	18	12	7	13	27	22	7	9
Ron Paul	4	6	1	1	2	3	1	1	1	2	*
Rick Santorum	1	9	*	*	*	*	*	*	*	*	*
Rick Perry	2	3	3	12	31	22	3	*	*	*	*
Herman Cain	1	*	43	23	*	1	*	*	*	*	*
Michele Bachmann	*	3	*	1	7	23	23	5	1	1	*
Jon Huntsman	*	*	*	*	*	*	*	*	*	*	*
Gary Johnson	*	*	*	*	*	*	*	*	*	*	*
Other											
None/DK/Ref.	32	26	32	39	37	35	44	45	41	50	53

ASK ALL:

Thinking about the nation's economy…

PEW.4 Since taking office, have Barack Obama's economic policies made economic conditions better, worse, or not had an effect so far?

	Better	Worse	No effect so far	**(VOL.)** Too soon/ early to tell	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
February 9-12, 2012	33	35	25	1	6
September 22-October 4, 2011	20	38	37	1	4
June 15-19, 2011	27	34	33	2	5
January 5-9, 2011	28	31	35	2	4
August 25-Sepember 6, 2010	27	32	36	2	4
June 3-6, 2010	23	29	35	3	9
February 3-9, 2010	24	27	42	3	5
December 9-13, 2009	30	24	39	3	4
September 30-Oct 4, 2009	31	20	42	4	3
July 20-26, 2009	24	21	46	3	6
June 10-14, 2009	26	16	49	4	4
April 14-21, 2009	26	17	47	6	4
March 9-12, 2009	14	15	64	4	3